DARWIN'S THEORY OF EVOLUTION

Never has a scientist, with one book, caused such a stir in the world as Darwin did with *The Origin of Species.* His ideas, the fruit of many years of patient thought and study, were attacked by learned and ignorant alike. He was called a madman, a deceiver, and an anti-Christian. Long and bitter quarrels arose, and most religious people of that time attacked him. They accused him of trying to destroy religion and morals completely, though Darwin, of course, had no such intention. His book dealt in a scientific way with a problem of science, and the only critics he answered were those who attacked him on scientific grounds. His refusal to return abuse did not stop his enemies, however. The newspapers were filled with letters and articles pouring scorn on the very idea of evolution and the less the writers knew about the subject, the more violent their attack was. Darwin, however, was well-supported by a few able scientists, who untiringly spread what he taught. He gathered so many facts, and built so surely on these unanswerable facts, that his ideas carried great weight once they were understood. After the first stormy outbursts had died away, men began to see things Darwin's way. Slowly and quietly, Darwin's teachings conquered the world.

(From *Seven Biologists* by T.H. Savory, F.E Joselin and John Walton)

EXERCISE 1: Find words or phrases in the passage which mean the same as:

	COLUMN A	**COLUMN B**
a)	process of change over the years due to environmental conditions	
b)	disturbance	
c)	starting-point	
d)	group of animals sharing many common characteristics	
e)	uneducated	
f)	in the same way; similarly; both	
g)	extremely unpleasant	
h)	for scientific reasons *(phrase)*	
i)	declining to reply back with insults *(phrase)*	
j)	cover with contempt *(phrase)*	
k)	fierce; aggressive	
i)	feverish attacks *(phrase)*	
m)	win; overcome	

EXERCISE 2: Choose the correct answer according to the passage.

1. Darwin's theory of evolution . . . . . .

A) failed to be understood clearly because it wasn't well supported with facts
B) was eventually admitted, although it had been severely attacked at first
C) was difficult to defend because of its unanswerable points
D) was regarded as a great success on scientific grounds
E) became popular only after he died

2. Darwin . . . . . .

A) replied to the criticism only of those who attacked his theory scientifically
B) was discouraged when he received such severe attacks from the scientists
C) was an anti-Christian who had been trying to alter the moral values of society
D) was able to find only a few supporters with his theory of evolution
E) also used unrepeatable words for those who had attacked him so severely

3. It is stated in the passage that . . . . . .

A) Darwin had missed some facts about the origin of species
B) Darwin couldn't answer some of the questions satisfactorily for fear that he would be isolated from other Christians .
C) Darwin received the most severe attacks from those who had the least knowledge of his theory
D) Darwin became confident only when a few of his close friends helped him spread his teachings
E) none of Darwin's previous books had caused such a quarrel among the public

EXERCISE 3: Complete the sentences by selecting words from Column B in EXERCISE 1.

• **1.** We now know there are four……of malarial parasite and all of them are transmitted by female Anopheles mosquitoes.
2. The unexpected arrival of the President at the conference caused quite a ……amongst the delegates.
3. Most English words have their……in Latin.
4. *Toy Story* was a movie that appealed to the young and the old……
5. The recent……cold has probably been the cause of the current flu epidemic.